

Altimeter

An underwater glider's altimeter is the primary instrument for preventing seabed strikes. It emits an acoustic pulse downward and measures the time-of-flight to the bottom, providing the glider's flight computer with a real-time altitude above the seafloor. When altitude drops below a programmed threshold, the glider commands an ascent.

Quick Reference

Parameter	Value
Typical setup time	30 min
Minimum personnel	1
Related topics	Mission Planning , Lab Test

What This Section Covers

- **Altimeter Installation** — Mechanical mounting, connector sealing, and orientation verification.
- **Software Configuration** — Enabling the altimeter in the flight computer and setting altitude thresholds.
- **Altitude Settings for Bottom Avoidance** — Choosing conservative target and minimum altitude values based on terrain.
- **Performance Verification** — Bench testing in a water tank and in-water verification on the first dive of each mission.

In This Section

:material-book-open-outline: **Slocum Altimeter One-Pager**

Quick-reference guide for lab testing and key altimeter sensor parameters.